

PRESS KIT

Temperance Industrial & Collegiate Institute Legacy Project

Reviving the history and legacy of an institution founded in 1892 in Claremont, Virginia (Surry County)

WHAT IT IS

The Temperance Industrial & Collegiate Institute Legacy Project researches, documents, and works to revive the legacy of the historic institution founded in Claremont, Virginia (Surry County), by Dr. John Jefferson Smallwood, a man born enslaved in 1863. Through archival research, oral history, and public outreach, the project traces the Institute from its 1892 founding and the Sawyer/Hay funding era, through the 1912 dedication of Lincoln Memorial Hall, Dr. Smallwood's death later that year, the school's 1913 charter reorganization, and its eventual 1926 acquisition by Marcus Garvey's Universal Negro Improvement Association — and asks what it would mean to bring the Institute's name and mission back to the community it once served.

THREE TRACKS, ONE PROJECT

- Documentary — a researched, source-based film, slated for a 2027 screening, telling the Institute's story.
- Name revival — restoring public recognition of the Institute's name and history.
- Cultural center — a long-term vision for a physical home for local history and community programming.

NOTABLE FIND

Original souvenir programme from the Institute's 1912 dedication ceremony at Lincoln Memorial Hall — a rare primary-source document that anchors the project's historical research.

BY THE NUMBERS

- Founded: October 12, 1892, in Claremont, Va. (Surry County)
- Lincoln Memorial Hall dedicated: May 1912
- Closed: 1929 · Campus demolished: 1941
- Also known as: the Smallwood Memorial Institute, the Smallwood-Corey Memorial Industrial and Collegiate Institute, and — under the UNIA — Universal Liberty University
- Core research document: fully sourced project chronicle

WHERE TO FIND THE PROJECT

- Website: smallwoodinstitute.org
- Podcast: available on Spotify
- Audio slideshow: on the project website
- Full research document: linked from the website
- Community submissions: open intake form on the website for photos, documents, and family history
- Support the project: GoFundMe or Patreon, both linked from the website

MEDIA CONTACT

- Name: Cory Howell, Legacy Ambassador (Communications)
- Also: Antonio D. Charity, Legacy Ambassador (Public Relations)
- Email: smallwood.edu.surry@gmail.com
- Phone: 757-356-2574
- Website: smallwoodinstitute.org

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

What is the Temperance Industrial & Collegiate Institute Legacy Project?

An independent research and public-history project documenting the Temperance Industrial & Collegiate Institute, founded in 1892 in Claremont, Virginia (Surry County), and working to bring public awareness — and eventually a physical presence — back to its history and name.

Who is behind this?

Cory Howell, Antonio Charity, and a team of volunteers, with no formal institutional affiliation at this stage.

Is this affiliated with any university, museum, or existing nonprofit?

[Answer honestly — e.g., “Not currently. The project is independent while nonprofit status is pursued.”]

Where does the research come from?

Archival records, historical newspapers, and primary-source documents — including an original programme from the Institute's 1912 dedication at Lincoln Memorial Hall — compiled into a fully sourced project document available on the website.

Is my donation tax-deductible?

Not currently. GoFundMe and Patreon contributions are not tax-deductible unless made through a registered 501(c)(3) or fiscal sponsor. [State current status — e.g., nonprofit formation in progress.]

What is the money used for?

Funding the documentary — equipment, professional film crews, and tours — along with the archival research behind it and the effort to carry the Institute's name and mission forward.

How can I help besides donating?

Share the project, follow the podcast, and submit any photos, documents, or family history connected to the Institute through the submissions form on the website.

I think my family is connected to the Institute — who do I contact?

Use the submissions form at smallwoodinstitute.org, or reach out directly at smallwood.edu.surry@gmail.com.

Will there be a documentary?

Yes — a documentary slated for a 2027 screening is one of the project's three core tracks, alongside the name-revival effort and the long-term goal of a cultural center.